

# Annual Report

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# 2025



**Belgium**

partner in development





# PREFACE

## Maxime Prévot

Deputy Prime Minister and Minister  
of Foreign Affairs, European Affairs  
and Development Cooperation

### Dear readers,

2025 will be remembered as a pivotal year for Belgian international cooperation.

The context in which we worked left no-one unaffected. Crises multiplied and reinforced each other: climatic, health, security and economic crises. From Sudan to Gaza, from Ukraine to the Sahel, conflicts continued to wreak havoc, displacing populations and silencing communities. Nearly two billion people currently live in contexts of extreme fragility.

At the same time multilateralism – an essential tool for overcoming global challenges – is being called into question, and often attacked head-on. Some of our traditional partners are retreating. Aid budgets are shrinking around the world.

Belgium is no exception in this regard. Budget constraints have forced us to cut our cooperation budget by 25%. This is not an abstract concept. Programmes had to be re-examined, commitments had to be adapted, choices had to be made.

I will not sugarcoat this reality. These decisions were difficult. But they were taken methodically, in concertation with the sector as a whole, and with a clear objective: to safeguard the essence and concentrate our resources where we can really make a difference.

It is in this context that I would like to acknowledge the work accomplished by the DGD in 2025.

This work is often invisible, but it is essential. This work involves prioritising, coordinating, and arbitrating. This work has made it possible to make the impact of the budget cuts as predictable as possible, to keep our action coherent, and to defend the principles that are the strength of Belgian cooperation.

I am proud of what has been accomplished. Proud of the professionalism demonstrated by our teams. Proud of the way they have continued to defend cooperation based on partnership, listening, and mutual respect, even under difficult circumstances.

2025 was also a year of strategic clarification.

We refocused our cooperation on three priority global public goods: climate, global health, and stability. This choice is not an abandonment, it is a refocusing. A way to concentrate our strengths where Belgian expertise can offer real added value, where the needs are the most pressing, where our work can truly make a difference.

Climate, because environmental crises and food insecurity affect the most vulnerable first and are a powder keg for the conflicts of tomorrow. Global health, because our health security depends on strong health systems around the world. Stability, because humanitarian action alone is not enough: we need to tackle the root causes of crises.

And to accelerate our impact, our focus is on three levers: skills, innovation, and the potential of young people and women. These are the driving forces behind the societies of tomorrow.

This new orientation also bolsters the coherence between our international cooperation and our foreign policy. It is no coincidence that these two

portfolios have been combined. Cooperation is not an isolated policy, it is a strategic lever for our external action, for the benefit of stability and in our own best interests.

While 2025 was the year of difficult decisions, 2026 will be the year of construction. The foundations have been laid. Now it is time to build on them.

I count on the commitment of each and every one of you – within the DGD and throughout the Belgian cooperation ecosystem – to make our international action what it should be: a tool of transformation, to bring about a fairer, more stable and more sustainable world.

Thank you for all your hard work. Thank you for your commitment.

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## INTRODUCTION

The past year has highlighted once again the extent to which our world is under pressure. The geopolitical context is continually and rapidly changing, and several regions – from the Middle East to the Sahel, and from Ukraine to the Great Lakes – are facing protracted crises. We can also feel the effects of these challenges in Belgium, not least in how international cooperation and humanitarian aid are organised and financed. There is a growing realisation around the world that we are not yet making sufficient progress together toward the Sustainable Development Goals.

But there is also hopeful news: international initiatives, such as the FFD4 Conference on Financing in Seville, show that new forms of collaboration are emerging: more inclusive partnerships, more shared responsibility, and new ways of mobilising resources for the current global challenges.

In this context, Belgian cooperation commits to a clear course of action. We are targeting our expertise where it has the most impact: climate, global health, and stability. These issues are crucial for our partner countries, but equally crucial for the security, health, and prosperity of Belgium and Europe.

To deliver on these priorities, we need to join forces – governments, CSOs, multilateral institutions, and the private sector. This is the only way we will achieve concrete and measurable results. This report presents the accomplishments of the past year, the impact of our actions and how to strengthen policy coherence for development.

In a world where crises are increasingly interwoven, investing in international cooperation and humanitarian aid means investing above all in prevention: preventing conflict, containing pandemics, mitigating climate change, and strengthening stability. This is a strategic choice that reduces the human, economic, and security costs in the long run – for our partners as well as for Belgium and Europe.

I wish you an enriching and inspiring read.

### Heidi Rombouts

Director general for Development  
Cooperation and Humanitarian Aid



# BELGIAN INTERNATIONAL COOPERATION AND HUMANITARIAN AID IN 2025

## OVERVIEW

### Identity Card

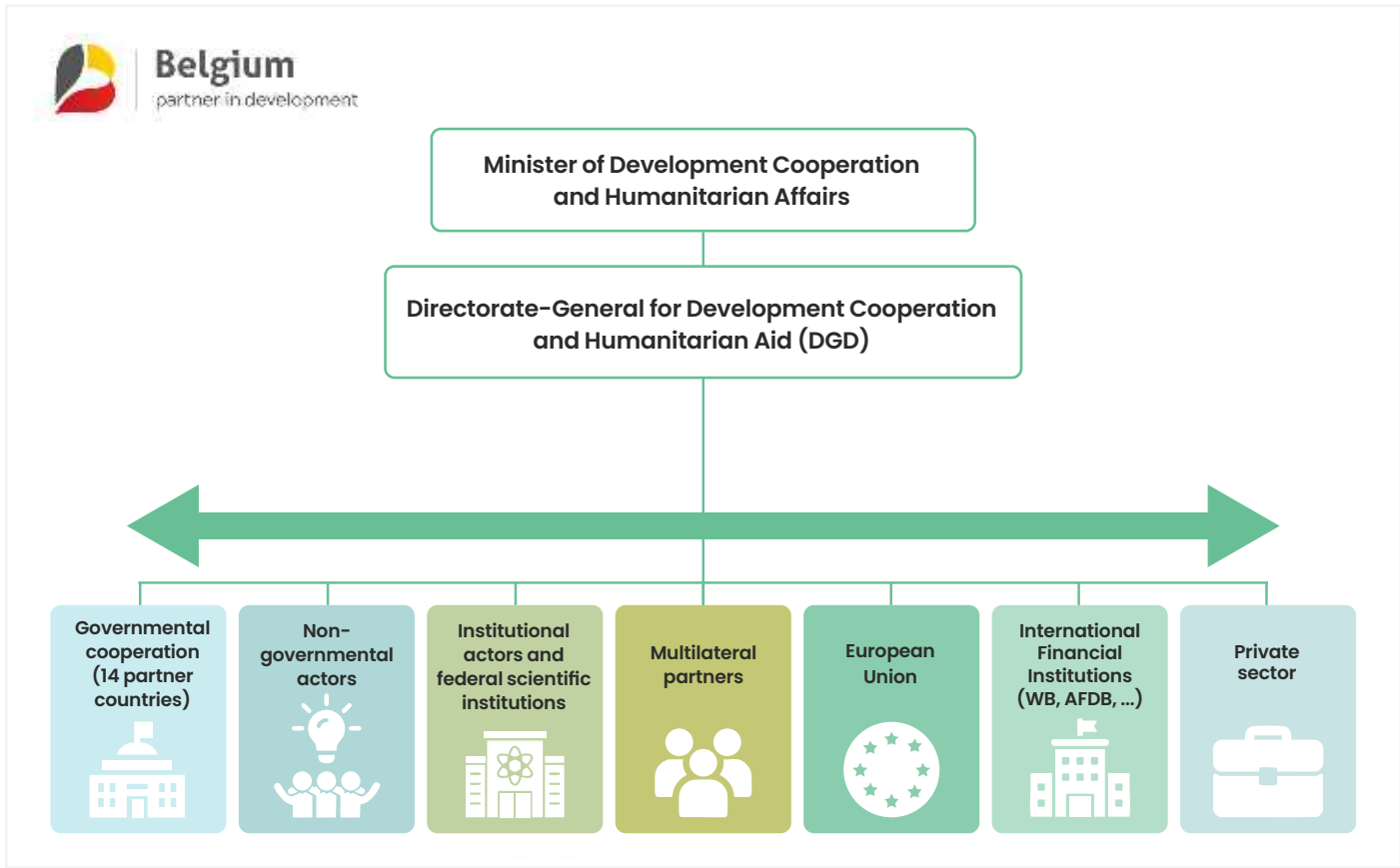
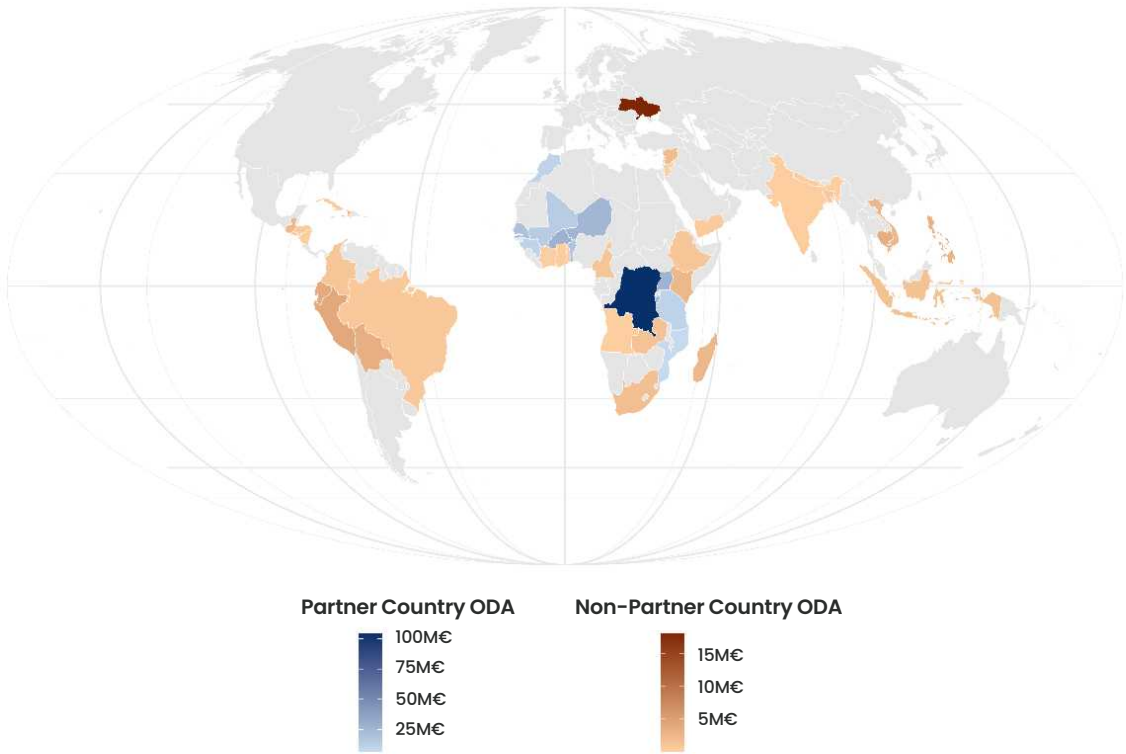


Figure 1: Complementarity of actors

Belgium's international cooperation relies on a wide range of actors, each offering unique added value to effectively address global challenges. *Governmental cooperation* - through Enabel - strengthens local institutions and systems in our partner countries so that governments can deliver better basic services. *Non-governmental actors* work directly with local communities and play a crucial role in strengthening civil society and fostering democratic debate and human rights, both internationally and in Belgium. Through *multilateral partners* such as the UN, EU, and the World Bank, Belgium can not only help ensure

a large-scale impact, but also exert influence and bolster multilateralism. *Humanitarian actors* provide rapid and fundamental emergency assistance to the most vulnerable, with flexible funding that saves lives in crisis situations. Finally, *the private sector* and BIO encourage sustainable local economic growth. Each actor is a crucial link in the bigger picture. This ensures a cohesive approach that creates more impact than each actor could achieve individually, and provides a powerful lever for stability, prosperity, and shared progress.



Provisional data subject to change.  
Disclaimer: The boundaries used on this map do not imply official endorsement or acceptance by the Belgian Government.

Figure 2: Bilateral Belgian ODA in 2025

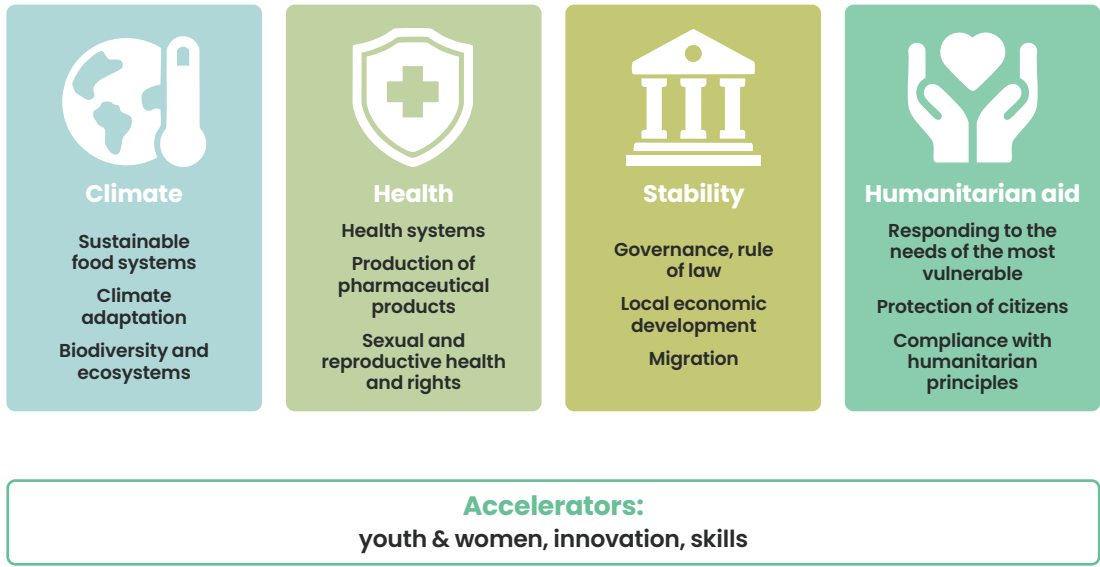


Figure 3: Themes

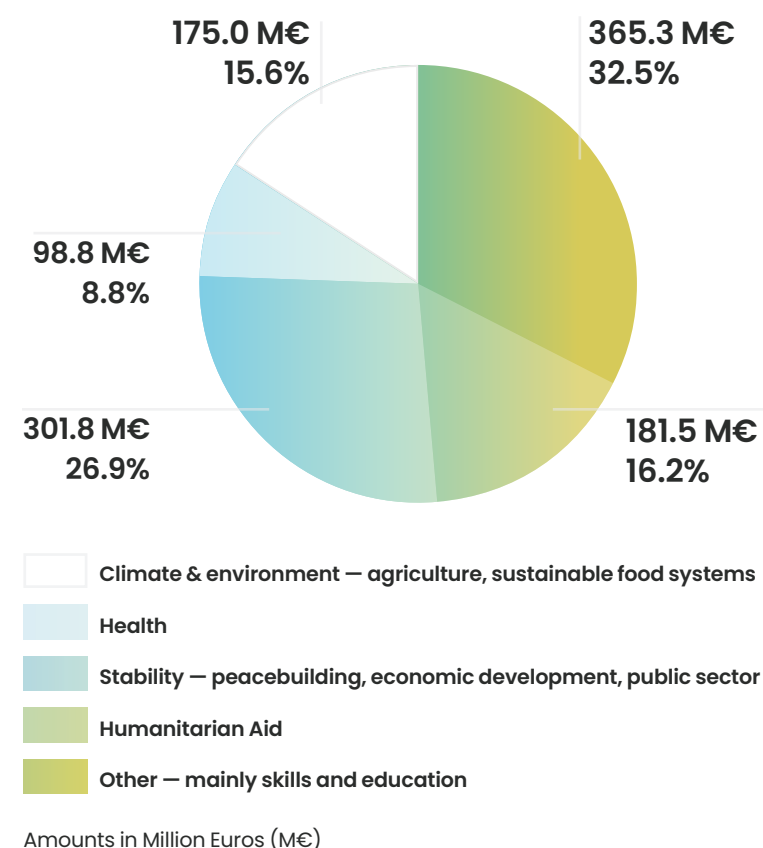


Figure 4: Belgian (DGD) ODA in 2025

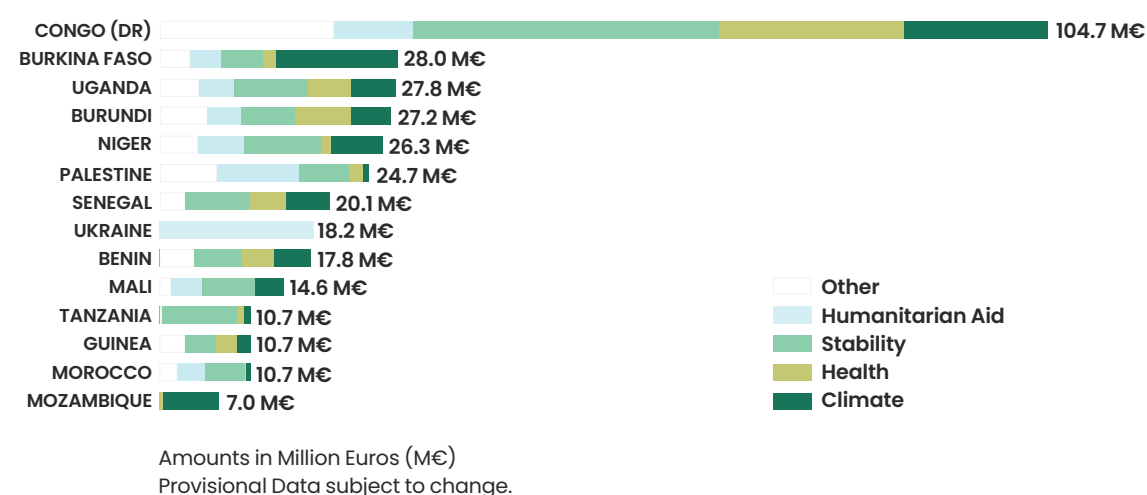


Figure 5: Belgian (DGD) ODA: Top Recipient Countries (2025)

## Ten years of the SDGs: A call to ramp up the global efforts

Ten years after the adoption of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), the world is still far behind schedule. Only 18% of the SDGs are on track for 2030, 18% are regressing, and nearly half are not making adequate progress. While there have been tangible improvements – such as increased access to electricity, education, social protection, and digital connectivity – the progress is undermined by conflict, climate change, rising inequality, and financial constraints. The exceedance of the 1.5°C limit in 2024 – the scientific threshold above which the most serious climate risks rapidly increase – underscores the urgency of accelerated action.

The UN and the Sustainable Development Report 2025 therefore call for urgent action in six critical areas: sustainable food systems, energy, digital connectivity, education, work, and climate and biodiversity.<sup>1</sup> Multilateralism is essential, as is a reform of the international financial system, to better finance global public goods.

With five years to go, fundamental acceleration is crucial, so that no-one is left behind, and the Agenda 2030 remains credible.

## United Nations Conference on Financing in Seville: an agreement in favour of multilateralism, international cooperation, and sustainable development

Since its launch in the early 2000s, the Financing for Development process has provided an essential framework for dialogue aimed to mobilise and link together national resources, official development assistance, private investment, debt management, trade, and innovation for the benefit of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

The adoption of the new framework document, the «Compromiso de Sevilla», marks a major step forward for multilateralism, in a context where international cooperation and sustainable development are often being called into question. This document reaffirms the importance of an integrated, solidarity-based approach to the global challenges.

Belgium made an active contribution to this success, with constructive participation in the preparatory negotiations. In particular, Belgium defended the operational effectiveness and efficiency of aid, better coordination between institutions, and the use of all available levers, and the «Leave No One Behind» principle.

This document was adopted at the 4<sup>th</sup> International Conference on Financing for Development, held in Seville in June 2025. Belgium called for renewed multilateralism, based on clear principles, coherent action, and tangible impact. This conference marked a turning point in the way international cooperation will be envisaged in the future, with the launch of various initiatives on the subject.

<sup>1</sup> <https://dashboards.sdgindex.org/>

## Rethinking international cooperation: reforms and new perspectives

The field of international cooperation is undergoing profound transformation at the global level, due to increasing geopolitical tensions, attacks on multilateralism and international law, and budgetary constraints.

In this context, 2025 saw a proliferation of international reform proposals, including the United Nations' UN80 initiative and the review of the OECD's Development Assistance Committee (DAC). At the same time, strategic reflections have emerged through forums for dialogue that have been set up, including "Donors in a Post-Aid World" by the think-tank ODI Global and the «Future of Development

Cooperation Coalition". In the same vein, the European Union aims to adapt its external tools to a more competitive and geopolitical environment, in particular through «Global Europe» and the «Global Gateway Investment Hub» initiative.

Given the significant impact of these reforms and reflections on the modalities and architecture of international cooperation, the DGD is fully involved and will continue to support these initiatives in 2026, thereby reaffirming its willingness to contribute to a more efficient, legitimate system that is suited to today's challenges.

### UN80: multilateral reforms

The United Nations celebrated its 80<sup>th</sup> year in 2025. Secretary general António Guterres sees this anniversary as an opportunity to take a close look at the future. With the UN80 initiative, his aim is to comprehensively modernise the UN. That is crucial, because the organisation currently faces both a funding and legitimacy crisis, with some even questioning its relevance.

The UN80 initiative aims to make the UN stronger, more efficient and future-proof once again. The planned reform is based on three major pillars: (1) Implement cost savings to address acute budget problems; (2) Analyse the full mandate of the UN. Over the years, more and more responsibilities were assigned to the organisation, with the result that it

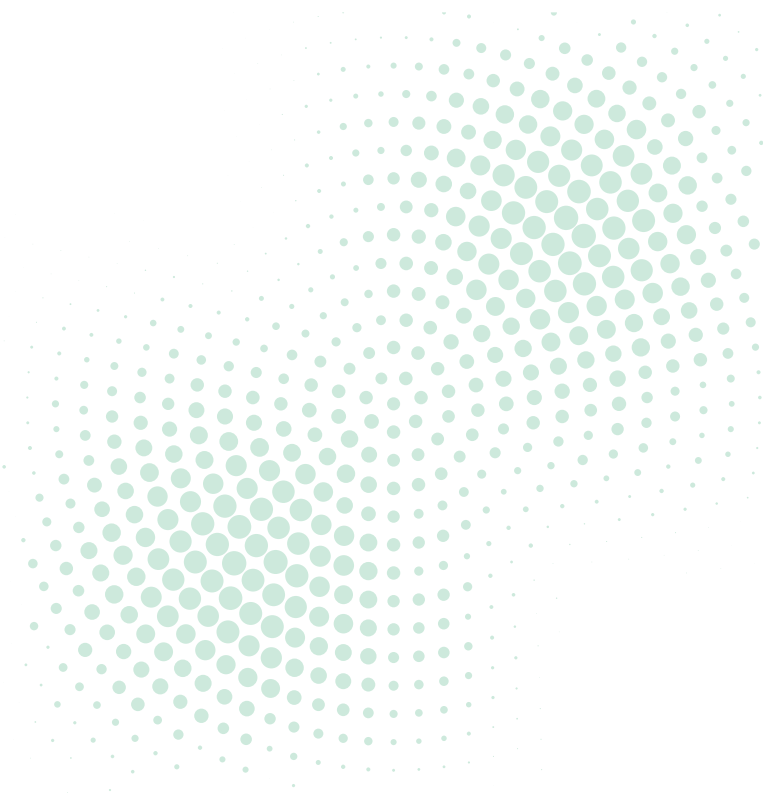
is now complex and sometimes fragmented; (3) Consider structural reforms within the UN as a whole, such as closer cooperation between agencies or even mergers if this leads to more impact.

For Belgium and the European Union, this planned reform is extremely important. We believe that the world needs a strong, credible, and modern UN that can continue to fulfil its core mission of promoting peace and security, protecting human rights and stimulating sustainable development. An efficient and modern UN makes international cooperation more impactful – and that is also in Belgium's interest.

## A tighter budget, targeted action

Faced with a budget reduced by €106 million in 2025, Belgium is adapting its international cooperation while respecting its existing commitments as much as possible. In 2025, the cuts came in particular from the under-utilisation of certain programmes and a review of new multilateral commitments, which made it possible to free up more than €90 million. These major cuts went hand in hand with a clear refocusing on Belgian priorities: climate, health, and stability. 2025 was therefore the first year of a progressive multi-year framework based on a 25% structural reduction in the budget, to be reached by 2027, combined with an in-depth strategic reflection with actors from the sector.

Against this backdrop, Belgium is refocusing its multilateral support on organisations whose mandates are deemed essential: human rights (OHCHR), global health (WHO, UNFPA, UNAIDS), gender equality (UN Women), migration (IOM), and the environment (UNEP), all of which retain their funding levels. Other contributions (GFATM, UNICEF, UNDP, GPE, ILO, FAO, WB EGPS, and EITI)<sup>2</sup> have been adjusted or put on hold, to avoid being spread too thinly and to strengthen impact. In addition, Belgian Development Cooperation continues to invest in international financing for the fight against climate change, as you will read later in this report. The objective remains clear: to protect priorities, maintain Belgian influence, and direct aid towards the most sustainable and strategic partnerships.



<sup>2</sup> Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (GFATM), United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Global Partnership for Education (GPE), International Labour Organization (ILO), Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO), World Bank Extractives Global Programmatic Support (WB EGPS), Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative (EITI).



# CLIMATE



The climate crisis does not stop at our borders. This global challenge is hitting vulnerable partner countries first and hardest, but Belgium is also increasingly experiencing the consequences. Our commitment to this priority issue is therefore based on three focus areas. (1) Biodiversity and ecosystems provide a natural buffer against climate change and are indispensable for natural resources and a stable environment. (2) Climate adaptation allows countries and communities to prepare for the inevitable impacts of a changing climate. (3) Sustainable and inclusive food systems are essential to meet the climate goals: with the right investments, agriculture can transform itself from a climate problem (with global emissions that are too high) into a powerful climate solution, with benefits for partner countries as well as for Belgium.

## Climate adaptation: the key to stability

With a contribution of €18.5 million in 2025, Belgium is the second largest donor to the Least Developed Countries Fund (LDCF), a financial instrument for the UN Climate Convention. The fund supports the least developed countries in preparing for a more climate-resilient future. The LDCF is recognised at the global level as a key actor, with a strong track record of supporting least developed countries (LDCs) in addressing climate adaptation for more than 20 years. It provides targeted support to the world's most vulnerable countries, their people, and ecosystems. The new climate adaptation strategy

is closely aligned with Belgian policy priorities, including resilient agriculture, climate action through enhanced biodiversity protection and support for early warning systems.

To date, the LDCF has funded 437 projects and programmes, benefiting 83.9 million people around the world. Moreover, this funding has resulted in strengthening climate-resilient land management of 15.2 million hectares of land. In line with the needs, the African continent has so far received around 71% of total LDCF funding.



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## Local resilience to climate change

The primary focus of Belgian climate finance is to help make LDCs more resilient. This is reflected in the figures: nearly half of our funding goes to LDCs, and the lion's share is focused on adaptation. This is essential in a broader context where adaptation is underfunded.

A concrete example of Belgian support is the LoCAL mechanism of UNCDF (United Nations Capital Development Fund): a programme focused on mobilising resources for local governments so that they in turn can build climate resilience. LoCAL aims to strengthen the institutional systems in countries, among other things by systematically integrating climate adaptation into budget planning. This helps build the capacity of local communities to adapt

to climate change. After all, the local level is best placed to estimate its own needs and contribute to solutions.

For example, Mozambique has implemented more than 30 climate-resilient infrastructure projects thanks to our country. In Uganda, 270,000 people directly benefited from climate-resilient investments in 2025, investments in climate-resilient infrastructure, water and sanitation, agroforestry, climate-smart agriculture, and energy efficiency. In Tanzania, LoCAL supports 21 districts in capacity building for climate adaptation, indirectly reaching around 1.5 million people.

## Belgian support for tropical forests, biodiversity, and climate

Through CAFI (Central African Forest Initiative) and CEBIOS (a programme of the Royal Belgian Institute of Natural Sciences), Belgium supports crucial tropical forest conservation efforts in the Democratic Republic of Congo. CAFI works to strengthen policy and governance, to combat deforestation, with an emphasis on sustainable land use planning and reducing emissions. CEBIOS focuses on capacity building and scientific insight, so that biodiversity is integrated into national strategies. CEBIOS actively cooperates with the *Centre de Surveillance de la Biodiversité* in this regard. In 2025, for example, the operations of the provincial office of this Congolese research centre were reinforced. These initiatives create synergies between the fight against climate change and halting biodiversity loss by protecting

forests as both a carbon sink and habitat for unique species. They underscore the importance of science-based policy, with local actors, researchers, and policymakers working together for sustainable development. In this way, Belgium makes a contribution to the global climate goals and preserving natural resources.



## Climate data:

### a crucial link for a global climate approach



Belgium is investing an additional €8.3 million in the UN Systematic Observations Financing Facility (SOFF) initiative, on top of the €11 million previously donated. With a total contribution of over €19 million, Belgium is now the largest donor of the SOFF.

Under the leadership of the World Meteorological Organization (WMO), the SOFF addresses critical gaps in weather and climate data, especially in vulnerable regions such as Africa. These data are crucial for early warning systems (EWS), which save lives and mitigate economic damage during extreme weather events such as storms, floods, and droughts. Investing in EWS is one of the most cost-effective climate adaptation measures.

Belgium is demonstrating not only financial decisiveness, but also diplomatic leadership. Since July 2025, our country has co-chaired the SOFF Steering Committee, together with the WMO, and is therefore hosting the Donor Steering Committee in Brussels in May 2026. At COP30, our Special Envoy for Climate and Environment played a key role in the launch of the SOFF Impact Bond, an innovative mechanism that attracts new funders, such as foundations and philanthropic associations.

This focus is part of Belgium's strategy to prevent loss and damage in vulnerable countries through preventive action. Cooperation between the FPS Foreign Affairs, the Belgian Science Policy, and the Royal Meteorological Institute of Belgium (RMI) ensures that data from the equatorial zone also improve our own weather forecasts. Climate security, resilience and adaptation remain core issues of Belgian policy.





## Innovation and sustainable food systems as a climate solution

Food systems are under pressure around the world. Agriculture is responsible for nearly one third of global greenhouse gas emissions. At the same time, agriculture itself is under considerable pressure from global warming. Extreme weather conditions threaten harvests and the incomes of

innovative solutions that make food systems more sustainable and resilient in the fight against climate change. In part thanks to Belgian support of €9.3 million in 2025, these innovations are reaching millions of farmers around the world. They safeguard harvests, improve soil health, and reduce



millions of farmers, with hunger and poverty as the result. Nevertheless, food systems offer an important opportunity: they can evolve from a major emitter to a climate solution. As such, Belgium is investing in sustainable food systems and innovations that bolster both food security and climate resilience.

Belgium is actively working to transform food systems through strategic partnerships, for example with CGIAR, the world's largest publicly funded agricultural research network. CGIAR develops

greenhouse gas emissions.

Between 2022 and 2024, CGIAR reached more than 20 million farmers in 62 countries with 471 innovations, including climate-resilient crops and sustainable agricultural practices. Biofortification programmes provided 300 million people with access to more nutritious crops. These innovations increase yields and incomes: in Africa, for example, improved maize varieties have generated more than \$1 billion annually in additional revenue.

Every euro Belgium invests in CGIAR generates exponential benefits. It strengthens the resilience of farmers in the global South, reduces hunger and poverty, and contributes to stable food systems around the world. At the same time, Europe and Belgium also benefit from this: investments in agricultural innovation keep food affordable, strengthen export markets, and limit the impact of climate and food crises. In this way, Belgium is helping to build a more sustainable future for all.





## Gender, climate, and agroecology: a sustainable future for the Sahel

The world's food systems are under pressure from climate change, biodiversity loss, conflict, and economic crisis, while dysfunctional food systems are themselves contributing to these problems. The Sahel is particularly vulnerable.

To remedy this situation, it is crucial to support inclusive, sustainable food systems, in particular thanks to the agroecological transition, which helps farmers to better withstand external shocks. Inclusion and gender equality play a key role: when women and marginalised groups are included, the resilience of communities and ecosystems increases.

Belgium is investing €50 million in the Sahel Climate programme via Enabel, which promotes agroecology with a focus on women and young

people. To date, 600 women's groups have received support to create income-generating activities, hundreds of savings and credit associations have been strengthened, and dozens of innovative agroecological initiatives have been developed.

At the same time, Belgium funds NGOs that are active in the Sahel. Thanks to the Feed Good programme, for example, women are more involved in food production and are becoming more self-reliant. However, interim evaluations have highlighted the fact that women still have a limited role in governance, and the inclusion of young women remains a challenge.

Belgium also promotes sustainable food systems within various multilateral frameworks.



©Enabel - Colin Delfosse



Garden of the Dan Zama Kouara School, Niamey, Niger ©Enabel  
- Colin Delfosse



## HEALTH

Global health, as a global public good is a priority within Belgian international cooperation. In a globalised world, not only viruses but also other health problems spread across national borders at lightning speed. We therefore work with our partners to build stable and high-quality health systems in the Global South, to strengthen local production capacity and access to vaccines and other medical products, and to promote sexual and reproductive health and rights. Belgium also has internationally recognised health expertise, which we actively draw on to help ensure a resilient and equitable global health architecture.



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### Health without borders:

#### working together for a world without sleeping sickness

Sleeping sickness is a tropical disease transmitted by the tsetse fly. Without treatment, the disease is fatal.

More than half of the individuals afflicted live in the Democratic Republic of Congo. Institutions such as the National Institute for Biomedical Research (INRB) and the National Sleeping Sickness Control Programme (PLNTHA) continue to work together with the Institute of Tropical Medicine in Antwerp (ITG) in 2025, to stop the spread of the disease in the country.

Belgium has carved out a leadership role within the international community to work with other countries and the World Health Organization, as well as the Gates Foundation, to eradicate the disease around the world. With success: over the past 20 years, the number of cases has fallen by 97%.

In the DRC, Congolese and Belgian institutions are training local detection teams to digitally store and process data on the disease. Together with the ITG, the National Sleeping Sickness Control Programme is testing new strategies for detecting the disease.

Innovations with mobile test kits make it easier to collect blood samples, even in remote areas. And the INRB now runs a full-fledged laboratory where these samples can be examined more rapidly.

All these innovations mean that it is easier for patients to get tested and treated. Since 2025, it has been possible to combine this more often with a consultation at a nearby health centre.

These are all important steps towards completely eradicating sleeping sickness. To prevent the disease from suddenly affecting more people again, it is important to also detect these latest cases. We are currently on track to eradicate the disease in the DRC by 2030. This year, the Central African Republic requested the ITG to explore a joint approach there as well.

In the fight against sleeping sickness, we are also learning in the meantime how to organise health systems smarter. As such, we are better protected when new diseases emerge or existing ones re-emerge, in the DRC and in Belgium.



©ITM - Blood sampling during a sleeping sickness screening in Bangumi



©ITM - Screening using the CATT test in the village of Bangumi



## The mRNA (Messenger RNA) technology transfer programme: a concrete commitment to equitable access

Belgium plays a leading role in the mRNA technology transfer programme set up by the WHO and the Medicines Patent Pool to strengthen local vaccine production in low- and middle-income countries. In Cape Town, the Belgian delegation observed tangible progress in November 2025: an operational R&D hub, trained experts, and voluntary technology transfer, with the COVID-19 vaccine as proof of concept. The aim is clear: to enable 15 partners to produce vaccines that are tailored to regional needs (HIV, tuberculosis, malaria), improve pandemic preparedness, and facilitate local autonomy in the production and supply chains for healthcare products.

Based on its conviction that health is a global public good, Belgium goes beyond traditional aid. It is renewing its commitment of €8 million over four

years, over 60% of which is dedicated to the mRNA programme and HTAP (Health Technology Access Programme)<sup>3</sup>, and relies on TEI MAV+ (Team Europe Initiative on Manufacturing and Access to Vaccines, Medicines and Medical Technologies) to structure the European effort. On the ground, mutually beneficial partnerships are proliferating, such as Quantoom Biosciences, which supplies technological solutions via commercial partnerships. Everyone wins: transfer of know-how, skilled jobs, diversified supply chains, and safer access to healthcare products.

These dynamics were highlighted at the Funders Meeting jointly organised by the DGD at the Egmont Palace in October. Belgium reaffirmed its vision of combining diplomacy, development, and innovation to build sustainable regional capabilities and ensure equitable access to healthcare technologies for all.



©Medicines Patent Pool



©Medicines Patent Pool



mRNA Technology Transfer Programme – ©Bryan Nicola Maxwell



mRNA Technology Transfer Programme – ©Bryan Nicola Maxwell

<sup>3</sup> The Health Technology Access Programme (HTAP), integrated in 2024 with the WHO mRNA Technology Transfer Programme and the Medicines Patent Pool, aims to strengthen sustainable development and global access to mRNA vaccines and therapeutics, particularly in low- and middle-income countries. The programme focuses on facilitating licensing, research, and local production.

## When health educates and education heals

To mark its 15<sup>th</sup> anniversary, the Educaid platform and Because Health organised a conference on the links between education and health in 2025.

Access to quality education and health go hand in hand, especially for children and young people: they foster better nutrition, better vaccination coverage, and help reduce infant mortality and HIV infections. Education also plays an essential role in sexual and reproductive health and rights, among other things by improving menstrual hygiene management and strengthening the prevention of gender-based violence – an issue that is even more crucial in a context where these rights are regressing.

Among the projects in the spotlight, the CHANCE programme by Humanity & Inclusion (HI), supported by the DGD in Uganda, aims to prevent disabilities and delayed development through early screening, and offers adapted solutions such as access to wheelchairs, sign language training, etc. It also encourages the inclusion of disabled children in schools. Of the 313 children aged 0 to 6 that have received support, 78% showed significant progress in their learning.

Education and health progress together: their cooperation is essential to guarantee the well-being and fundamental rights of every child and young person.



Joel Loku, known as Jojo, is a 4-year-old boy who receives support from the CHANCE project, funded by the DGD. He continues his rehabilitation at home with Nancy Gloria Ayugi, his physiotherapist employed by HI. © Crolle Agency / HI



## A crucial time to fight back against the reversals

### of sexual and reproductive rights

In 2025, sexual and reproductive rights faced an increasingly polarised global context, marked by attacks on gender issues and a retreat from international commitments. The withdrawal of the United States and the rise of opposition movements exacerbated the reversal, making it even more complex to defend these rights.

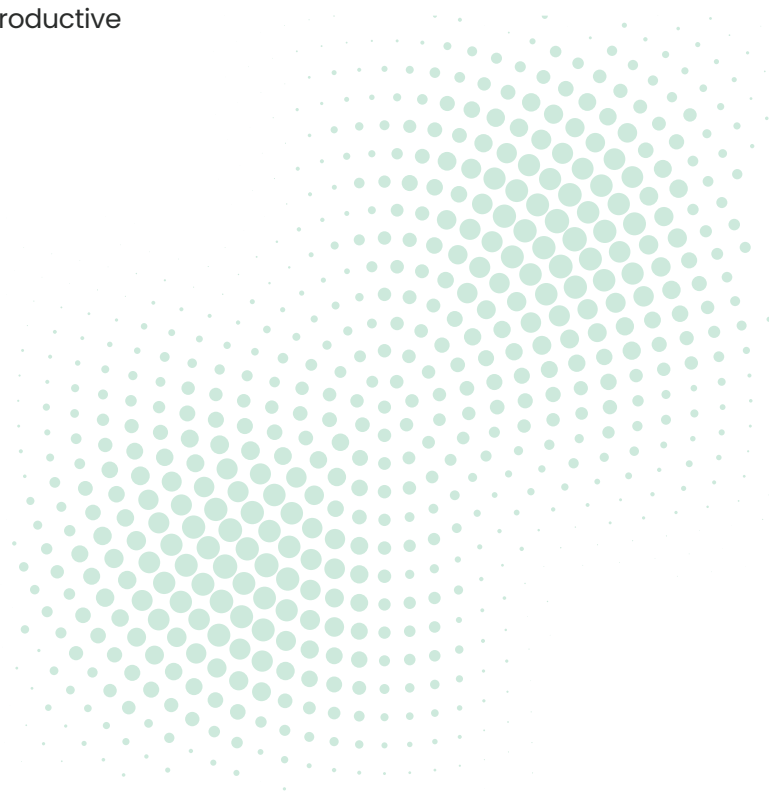
Despite these challenges and budgetary constraints, Belgian cooperation has been able to maintain funding for UNFPA and UN Women's regular resources at equivalent levels, in order to safeguard essential gains and support vital projects in over 150 countries.

In the past, this multilateral approach resulted in major advances: maternal mortality fell by 40% in two decades, teenage births dropped by a third, and the number of women using modern contraceptives doubled.

Thanks to the support of multiple partners – including Belgium – the UNFPA Supplies partnership has given 25 million women access to reproductive

health services, thereby preventing nearly 10 million unplanned pregnancies and saving over 200,000 lives. The UNFPA Maternal and Newborn Health Thematic Fund continued to play a key role, with 30.8 million women benefiting from safe deliveries since 2008.

In the context of our governmental cooperation, Enabel has continued its investments in sexual and reproductive health and rights in six countries, including Burkina Faso, with concrete progress: solar-powered blood banks have been set up, a telemedicine pilot has been launched for high-risk pregnancies, centres have been set up for treating gender-based violence and nearly 200 community workers have been trained. These actions demonstrate our commitment to defending rights and strengthening healthcare systems, even in a more challenging global environment.



## STABILITY

Belgium sees a stable world with resilient societies as an essential global public good. Conflict, inequality, and oppression also affect the security, democratic norms, and economic interests of Belgium and Europe. Belgian international cooperation therefore makes targeted investments in the foundations of stability. Good governance and a robust rule of law create trust, predictability, and better basic services, while strengthening democratic norms that are increasingly under pressure around the world. Respect for human rights, open civil space, and gender equality help create inclusive societies. Local economic development also plays a stabilising role: it creates jobs, opportunities, and a social safety net; it leads to reliable value chains and offers new prospects for local and Belgian companies and consumers. Migration and stability are also closely interwoven. Structural challenges such as a lack of good governance, poverty, and climate change undermine stability and development. As a result, people are less likely to migrate based on free, positive choice, and more likely to migrate out of necessity.





## Belgian cooperation for sustainable value chains and sustainable growth

In 2025, BIO, the Belgian Investment Company for Developing Countries, approved 30 new investments, worth €240 million. One of the most emblematic projects involves funding for Biophyto, a Benin-based company specialising in organic fertilizers and pesticides.

With this loan, BIO is continuing a years-long trajectory of Belgian support.

Founded in 2011 by a local agricultural consultant, Biophyto was quickly identified as a promising player by Enabel, the Belgian agency for international cooperation. Thanks to the agency's intensive support, the company was able to professionalise through targeted technical assistance and small-scale financing.

Biophyto reached a milestone in 2021 when Enabel teamed up with Kampani, a Belgian impact investor focused on the 'missing middle' in the agri-sector: companies too big for microcredit but not yet able to access the mainstream capital market.

The loan from BIO marks a promising new phase in this growth path. This funding provides the necessary clout for substantial scale-up and regional expansion, and will take the company to the next level.

Biophyto's success story illustrates the strength of the Belgian ecosystem. By combining the complementary expertise of Enabel (guidance), Kampani (scale-up) and BIO (large-scale investment), Belgium has created a powerful lever for the local private sector. This integrated approach acts as an engine for inclusive economic development, which is the basis of prosperity and long-term stability for local communities.





## When innovation and private-sector commitment contribute to global public goods

The funding set aside by the DGD for the Impact Licensing Initiative (ILI) supports a simple goal: to put useful technologies into the hands of people in low- and middle-income countries. The challenge is to bolster climate, health, and stability through concrete and accessible solutions.

### How does it work?

ILI secures the rights from companies and research centres to adapt their patents, to give them a strong social or environmental impact in low- and middle-income countries. ILI then makes it possible for local manufacturers to produce these technologies at low cost. This low-cost innovation approach opens up access to: solutions for producing green hydrogen; cooling systems for vaccines, medicines, and food that keep them cold for up to three weeks without energy consumption; tools to make it easier for people who can't read to take their medicines.

These technologies, produced locally, strengthen the economies of partner countries while meeting essential needs.

In exchange for access to its technological adaptations, ILI incorporates clear requirements in its contracts regarding impact on the Sustainable Development Goals. This framework reassures impact investors, who know that their funds are generating real social benefits. At the same time, new business opportunities are created for inventors, who can then use these adapted technologies in Belgium. Thanks to this model, every euro of ODA attracts more private investment. For example, in 2025, ILI launched Impact Licensing Studio, with €1.7 million in private capital.

In the same year, ILI also:

- implemented a European Horizon 2020 project aimed at integrating impact licensing into the European Union's Research & Development policy;
- started a collaboration with the United Nations Technology Bank for the Least Developed Countries to determine technological needs.

In a nutshell: impact licensing helps to spread essential innovations, stimulate local activity, and reduce dependence on traditional aid, while creating a veritable virtuous circle between the private sector, innovation, and human development.



COOSHA BV: green hydrogen based on an invention by Solhyd (KU Leuven) developed with Flemish funding, scaled up with DGD funding. Solar panels capture humidity from the air, converting it into low-pressure green hydrogen stored in textile bags that can power a fridge and a stove.



IKIC thermostatic refrigeration based on a technology developed by Colruyt with Flemish funding, scaled up with DGD funding.



READ: a book containing medicines and dosage instructions developed with DGD funding



**Commitment to democratic space:**

**from Civic Space to Team Europe Democracy**

To counteract the shrinking space for civil society, Belgium launched the Civic Space call in 2021 and the Civic Space Initiative in 2023. In this way, we intensified our commitment to democratic participation, the protection of fundamental freedoms, and building the capacity of CSOs.

One of the supported projects is based in Burkina Faso, and run by the DCAF-Geneva Centre for Security Sector Governance. This successful project promotes press freedom and digital space in difficult circumstances, combats fake news on social media, and helps young people recognise false information. The project also focuses on protecting the rights of women, youth, and other vulnerable people in the media sector. DCAF works with 7 local organisations on the project, for a total amount of €1,000,000.

In addition, Belgium works within the Team Europe Democracy (TED) to strengthen European coordination for research and action defending democratic values. This network supported the Team Europe Initiative for the Special Criminal Court in the Central African Republic in 2025. The TED report turned out to be essential in the credibility of this process, and renewed motivation for member states and the EU to continue supporting the Special Criminal Court in its second mandate.





## Climate and migration: taking action in the Sahel

Climate change is disrupting livelihoods in the Sahel. Droughts, floods, and land degradation are putting pressure on agriculture, which accounts for 30–50% of the GDP in Sahel countries and provides employment for the majority of households. As of June 2025, over 1.7 million people were internally displaced by climate disasters in the Sahel. Transhumance – the seasonal movement of herds – is also being disrupted by the scarcity of resources, increasing tensions.

In 2024–2025, Belgium provided funding for the TAAMA project of the IOM (International Organization for Migration), worth €5 million euros, in order to better understand migratory movements in the Sahel and strengthen the resilience of communities in Mali. Our partnership made it possible to train 677

young people in professions linked to the green economy, restore 200 hectares of degraded land and set up an early warning system to anticipate conflicts linked to pastoral mobility. This pilot project highlights sustainable solutions in the face of forced displacement linked to climate change.

Belgium has also allocated €50 million for the Sahel Climate programme, implemented by Enabel, to combat desertification and the effects of climate change. By improving management of natural resources, restoring ecosystems, and strengthening the resilience of populations, the project is also helping to reduce forced displacement. Concrete results are visible, with over 26,000 hectares of land already restored.





## Building stability

### in one of the world's most challenging crises

In Palestine, Belgian development cooperation is turning its commitment to stability into concrete action within one of the most complex and fragile contexts in the world. Following the attacks by Hamas against Israel in October 2023, Israel launched a devastating war in Gaza. The situation is also escalating in the West Bank, due to the expansion of illegal settlements and increasing violence. This has seriously hampered the implementation of our cooperation programmes and demanded major flexibility from our partners, as well as specific adaptations to our programmes. Nevertheless, Belgium is determined to address structural vulnerabilities and strengthen long-term social stability through its governmental and non-governmental cooperation. In this way, we are helping to build a sustainable and inclusive Palestinian state.

In the context of the bilateral programme, Enabel is focusing on access to employment in order not only to help make Palestinian youth more employable in the labour market, but also support entrepreneurship and build institutional capacity within the labour market. In a context of high youth unemployment, it is precisely local economic development focused on young people that forms a powerful lever for social cohesion. Belgian non-governmental actors are also bolstering local stability by supporting civil society. Their programmes are focused on respect for international law, good governance, and education, as well as creating economic opportunities and ensuring the right to food and resources in rural areas, among other things.

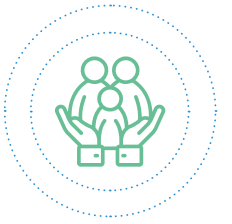


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## HUMANITARIAN AID



Global humanitarian needs continued to rise in 2025 as a result of climate change, geopolitical tensions, protracted conflicts, and violations of international humanitarian law. The result was a growing gap between the needs of the affected populations and the resources available to meet them effectively. Faced with this reality, Belgium reaffirmed its commitment to a robust, efficient, and equitable humanitarian architecture in 2025, based on flexible and predictable funding and with a priority focus on protection (protection of civilians), access (safe and unhindered access to populations in need), gender (equality and the fight against gender-based violence), and localisation (rebalancing power dynamics). At the same time, the Humanitarian-Development-Peace Nexus (coordination between emergency aid, development, and peacebuilding) is still the core focus of Belgium's actions, to support structural and sustainable solutions in fragile contexts and crisis situations. In 2025, the humanitarian budget was exempted from any cuts, and was kept at €170 million, 70% of which has been allocated flexibly, giving humanitarian organisations the flexibility they require to respond effectively to needs.



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## A new humanitarian strategy for a changing world

As the humanitarian sector changes, so does our approach. Protracted conflicts, climate disasters, polarisation: there is no shortage of challenges. Belgium has therefore re-examined its 2014 humanitarian strategy to respond to this reality, based on an evaluation carried out in 2022 and broad consultations conducted in 2025. With nearly €170 million annually, we want to be where it counts: in the most challenging areas, alongside communities. The new strategy introduces major changes: it puts people at the centre, with their autonomy and participation as key principles. It introduces

the importance of humanitarian diplomacy to guarantee access and protection for populations, and the nexus approach, in which humanitarian aid, development, and peace are linked to tackle the root causes of crises. It incorporates the ethical aspect, risk management, and more strategic partnerships, always based on flexible, multi-year financing, adapted to emergencies and protracted crises. In an uncertain context, we are opting for action and solidarity, with a clear commitment to putting people at the heart of every decision. The new strategy has been published in January 2026.



### BELGIAN HUMANITARIAN STRATEGY



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## Support for flexible funds:

### rapid mobilisation of humanitarian aid in the wake of Hurricane Melissa in the Caribbean

In late October 2025, Hurricane Melissa passed over Jamaica and eastern Cuba, leaving a trail of devastation. Thanks in part to flexible contributions from Belgium, humanitarian organisations on the ground were able to provide immediate life-saving assistance.

Flexible funds play a crucial role in this regard. These are funding mechanisms that are replenished throughout the year by different donors. In the event of a sudden crisis, these funds can allocate resources immediately. Belgium is a strong advocate of this approach and supports several similar funds.

For example, Belgium contributes €3.5 million every year to the Disaster Response Emergency Fund (DREF) of the International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC). In addition, our country provides €5 million for the Immediate Response Account (IRA) of the World Food Program (WFP) and €17 million for the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) of the United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA).

The impact of this support is clearly visible. The DREF released more than 7.5 million Swiss francs – more than €8 million – for aid in Jamaica, Cuba, and the Dominican Republic. As a result, the local Red Cross associations could spring into action immediately.

The IRA also moved quickly, making \$16 million available for the Caribbean community and another \$7.55 million for Cuba, the Dominican Republic, and Haiti. In turn, the CERF set aside \$21.5 million to strengthen emergency response in these countries.

## Belgium bolsters international

### call to action for Palestinian children

In September, during the ministerial high-level week of the United Nations General Assembly, Belgium organised a side event with Jordan and the European Union on the Call to Action for Palestinian children in the West Bank and Gaza.



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Together with Jordan, Belgium took the lead in this international call to action, in which demands have been made since 2024 for an immediate ceasefire, respect for international law, safe humanitarian access, and a coordinated UN response. The side event brought together key humanitarian organisations, including OCHA, UNICEF, and Save the Children. The stories of children from the West Bank and Gaza took centre stage, along with the reality on the ground and the serious impact on their lives. There was a lot of interest, and the event successfully drew international attention to the plight of Palestinian children. Participants were informed about the call to action and were encouraged to take concrete steps to protect these children and to save their lives.



Minister Prévot reiterated Belgium's unmistakable message: international humanitarian law and child protection are not optional principles. Our country continues to support humanitarian organisations working in extremely difficult conditions and insists on strict compliance with the four humanitarian principles: humanity, neutrality, impartiality, and independence.



79 members have already joined to date, including 74 UN member states and 5 organisations; a powerful signal of solidarity and commitment to protect Palestinian children.



## Humanitarian-Development

### -Peace (HDP)

## Nexus and multi-actor approach in Kasai

The context of the DRC is a particularly good illustration of the importance of the HDP nexus approach, which allows humanitarian, development, and peace actors to work in complementarity with each other on the basis of a shared analysis of the context and risks. As such, Belgium has made a strong contribution to the implementation of this approach in the Democratic Republic of Congo through our joint presidency of the Nexus Donor Group since 2024.

Kasai is a good example. Although we still need to make progress, coordination between the various actors (technical and financial partners, multilateral agencies, national and international NGOs) and strong ownership by the provincial authorities have been impressive. The region has experienced various crises, including Kamuina Nsapu, with major humanitarian, economic, and security consequences.

Although the situation remains fragile today, the HDP Nexus approach has helped ensure lasting improvement in food security in the pilot territories, and has made it possible to put in place long-term solutions for forcibly displaced people. In concrete terms, the services of the government are playing a bigger role in securing the food supply. This means support for production (inputs, seeds, cultivation techniques), better access to land, and more favourable conditions for selling and marketing the harvest. ➤

The government wants to duplicate this model of outstanding coordination between actors at the provincial level in other regions of the country. Belgium is proud to support these efforts as joint president of the Nexus Donor Group. As such, it is also involved, alongside other technical and financial partners, national and international NGOs, and government authorities, in the Nexus Consultative Group (GCN) launched in 2025 by the Congolese Ministry of Planning to allow the Congolese government to play a leading role in implementing the Nexus approach on its territory.



In 2021, before the Nexus approach was implemented in the region, 49% of the population was in a situation of food insecurity, according to IPC figures. By 2025, this figure had fallen to 25%, or a halving in 3 years.

In 2021



In 2025



In some areas, such as Kamunia, food insecurity is down to 5%.



This Nexus approach has also helped to reduce local conflicts between different groups thanks to dialogue with local chiefs, leading to several peace agreements in the province.

According to OCHA, internal displacements have also fallen sharply in recent years. Indeed, in 2017, 1.4 million people were forcibly displaced. By 2025, the figure was just 130,000 in the region.





## POLICY COHERENCE FOR DEVELOPMENT: Recommendations from the Advisory Council on Policy Coherence for Development (CCPD-ABCO)



The results of Belgian Development Cooperation may come under pressure from other policies – Belgian or international. For example, potential negative impacts on developing countries from agricultural, trade, climate, or intellectual property policy. As such, the Law on Development Cooperation (19 March 2013) emphasises the importance of policy coherence for development (PCD). The law defines PCD as a (freely translated):

“PCD is a process to ensure that the objectives and results of a government’s development cooperation policies are not contradicted by that government’s policies in other areas that have an impact on developing countries, and that these other policies support development goals wherever possible.”

For the DGD, it is crucial that other governments and departments consider the impact of their policies on developing countries – including the most fragile. As this is outside the DGD’s direct sphere of control, dialogue with other federal entities, the federated states, and the EU is essential to ensure PCD.

This report illustrates elsewhere how DGD has contributed to policy coherence for development in a number of specific cases. For example, through consultation and influence, the interests of the Least Developed Countries (LDC) category were defended ahead of the Conference on Financing for Development (see article on FFD4). Efforts were also made in terms of technology transfer to the Global South (see article on the Impact Licensing Initiative) and on encouraging local vaccine production (see related article). These examples demonstrate how the DGD is working through partnerships and dialogue to mitigate the potential negative impacts of other policies on developing countries.

In 2026, the Special Evaluation Office (SEO) will conduct an evaluation on policy coherence for development. There will be a specific focus on PCD within the areas of climate, international health, and stability. As of next year, the findings of this evaluation will be included in this annual report, and this will provide an even more complete picture of how PCD is being achieved in practice, and which obstacles remain.

This chapter briefly presents the recommendations of the Advisory Council on Policy Coherence for Development (CCPD-ABCO) – an independent advisory council composed of scientists and civil society – made in 2025 to inform the reflections on policy coherence for development. The recommendations are addressed to the various federal departments and policy levels, including the FPS Foreign Affairs, and are shown here as formulated by the CCPD-ABCO as recommendations.

## The World Summit for Social Development

The Second World Summit for Social Development (WSSD2) took place in Doha between 4 and 6 November 2025. This summit provided unique political momentum to reinforce the objective of the Agenda 2030 – eradication of poverty in all its forms and dimensions, including extreme poverty. In the run-up to the summit, the CCPD-ABCO published recommendations to strengthen Belgium’s positions and put policy coherence for development centre stage.

The recommendations call on Belgium to promote a vision in which all relevant policy areas – from trade and finance to agriculture, climate, migration, and defence – make a cross-cutting contribution to social

development. Belgium is encouraged to defend the role of the International Labor Organization (ILO) within the multilateral system and to advocate a review of national policies that violate core labour standards. In this regard, the CCPD-ABCO also calls for a gradual shift from minimum wage to living wage, and asks to formalise the informal economy, so that social protection for all is enshrined in law.

The recommendation highlights the need to address discrimination and exploitation of women and girls, hold companies accountable for human rights in their chains, and link social and environmental sustainability more closely.



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## The Fourth United Nations

### Conference on Financing for Development (FFD4)

In the run-up to the Fourth United Nations Conference on Financing for Development (FFD4), held in Seville in July, the Advisory Council on Policy Coherence for Development (CCPD-ABCO) issued recommendations to the Belgian government. The recommendations focus on how Belgium can strengthen policy coherence for development within five central pillars of development finance.

For the first pillar – mobilising domestic and international financial resources – the CCPD-ABCO advocates, among other things, expanding the OECD framework on unitary taxation of multinational corporations and improving the minimum tax mechanism for multinationals within that same OECD framework, as well as a UN framework convention on tax. Within the second pillar, on finance and the private sector, the Council calls for more transparency and development impact in private investment and blended finance.

As regards international development cooperation (third pillar), it calls for a reconfirmation of the 0.7% target and for more democratic international governance. The CCPD-ABCO also calls for a multilateral framework for debt restructuring, that will allow to sustainably address the debt burden of developing countries (fourth pillar). Finally, the recommendations call for attention on a just and inclusive global financial architecture (fifth pillar), in which systemic failures are addressed and developing countries are given more of a voice.

## International tax cooperation

### within the United Nations

According to the CCPD-ABCO, the ongoing negotiations regarding a new UN Framework Convention on International Tax Cooperation offers a unique opportunity to make the global tax system fairer, in particular for historically disadvantaged developing countries. The CCPD-ABCO calls on Belgium to advocate for policy coherence for development in these negotiations. International tax arrangements must strengthen, not undermine, development policy.

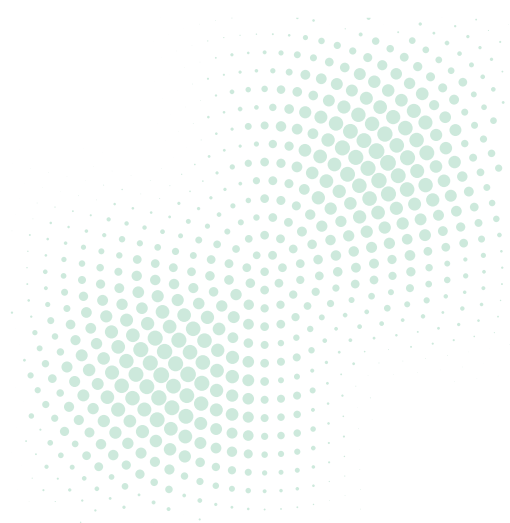
In the CCPD-ABCO's view, the framework convention must contribute to fair and effective taxation, with a particular focus on multinationals and the assets of wealthy individuals. The CCPD-ABCO proposes four groups of priorities: (1) reform of taxes on multinational corporations through unitary taxation of global profits, a fair distribution based on the actual activity in each country, an increased minimum rate of 25%, and mandatory public reporting on a country-by-country basis; (2) international standards for taxing the assets of wealthy individuals; (3) a common definition of illicit financial flows, regulation thereof and enhanced information exchange among states; and (4) an alignment of tax systems with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to support the UN 2030 Agenda and the Paris Climate Agreement.

## The transactional approach

### and mutually beneficial partnerships

These recommendations analyse the implications of the more transactional approach Belgium is introducing in its foreign policy and international cooperation. The CCPD-ABCO acknowledges that this approach can help ensure better strategic coordination between development, diplomacy and defence, while advancing global public goods and the 2030 Agenda, but warns of risks to policy coherence for development if official development assistance (ODA) is made secondary to Belgium's economic, security, or migration interests. Key principles of aid effectiveness risk being undermined, such as ownership by partner countries, alignment with their needs, and the focus of ODA on contexts with the biggest development needs.

The CCPD-ABCO therefore calls for the international principles of aid effectiveness to be respected, while ensuring that ODA is focused exclusively on global public goods and sustainable development; the integrated 3D approach (diplomacy, defence, development) also needs to be part of the broader framework of policy coherence for development.



## Mirror measures

### and policy coherence for sustainable food systems

These recommendations argue that European policy that contributes to sustainable food systems through health and environmental standards also needs to be applied to imported agricultural and food products. These so-called mirror measures link access to the European market to compliance with the same production standards that apply within the EU.

The recommendations emphasise that mirror measures are a tool to support the global transition to sustainable production and consumption patterns, in line with sustainable development goals. It provides that applying these measures is systematic and coherent within EU legislation.

The CCPD-ABCO recommends that the principle of mirror measures should become standard practice and strictly applied throughout the European Union, that the legitimacy of these measures be strengthened by promoting coherence and multilateral cooperation, that existing legislation be made more coherent, and that it must be ensured that the introduction of these measures does not have a negative impact on vulnerable countries and producers in international value chains. This includes ex-ante impact assessments, support for local actors in complying with EU regulations, and transparent price changes so that the cost of compliance is borne by importers rather than producers.

Implementing these mirror measures can help ensure fair trade, the protection of health and the environment, and the promotion of fair working conditions, while supporting a socially just and environmentally responsible international agro-industrial transition.



## INTEGRITY

# Effective implementation of the integrity charter by Belgian Development Cooperation 2025

## FRAMEWORK

The regulatory framework provides that the minister, in his annual report to parliament, includes a progress report and recommendations on the application of the integrity charter (article 35,3° Law on Belgian Development Cooperation). This 2025 progress report on integrity is based on the annual integrity survey conducted among all actors of the Belgian Development Cooperation, as well as on the results of the recognition procedure of NGOs and Institutional Actors carried out in 2025. The response rate to the survey in 2025 was 100%, a good illustration of the importance the sector places on integrity.

In 2018, the various actors of Belgian Development Cooperation (NGOs, institutional actors, Enabel, and BIO), in collaboration with the DGD and the cabinet of the then Minister of Development Cooperation, drew up an integrity charter containing 10 integrity-related commitments. In this way, a culture of integrity is fostered in Belgian Development Cooperation, whereby violations of integrity are prevented as much as possible, problems are detected, whistleblowers can come forward in an accessible, safe manner and appropriate support is provided to victims.

This integrity charter has been legally binding<sup>4</sup> since 1 July 2023, with an important development in 2025: during the new round of recognition for NGOs and institutional actors, among other things, actors were screened in terms of their level of integrity based on the 10 conditions of the integrity charter. The result was positive and showed that as of 2025, the integrity charter is being implemented effectively.<sup>5</sup>

This success story is the result of years of effort. Eight years ago, the sector decided to structurally address the question of integrity. Through engagement, supported by regulatory incentives, the sector has boosted its integrity efforts to a higher level each year. Cooperation and cross-fertilisation at the sector level, under the impetus of the recognised federations<sup>6</sup>, and dialogue-based cooperation with the FPS Foreign Affairs and the various cabinets, made this change possible.

<sup>4</sup> Via the Royal Decree of 28 February 2023 on integrity

<sup>5</sup> In the annual survey on integrity, all organisations also indicated that they were still meeting the 10 points of the integrity charter.

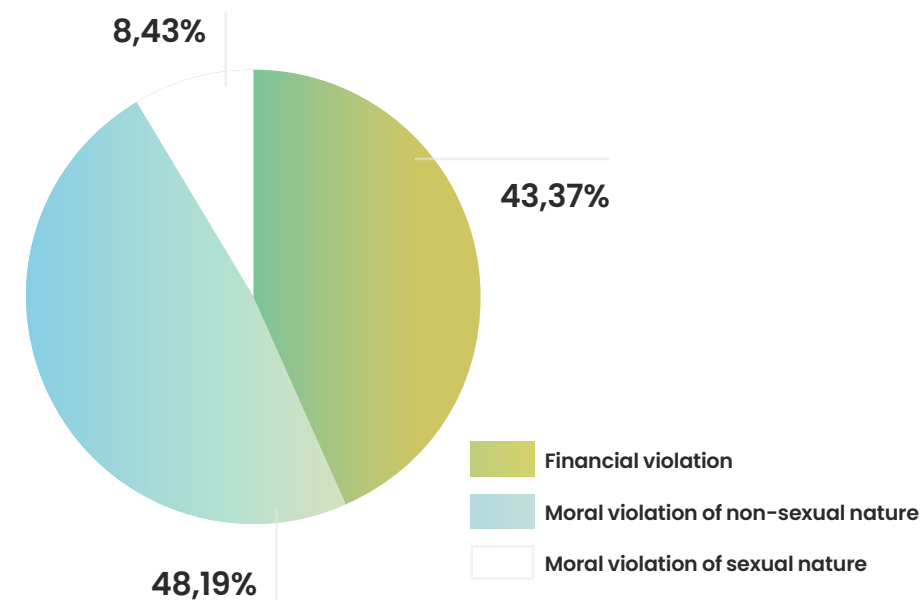
<sup>6</sup> Cooperation between the integrity officers of the NGOs and IAs, facilitated among others by the federations through an integrity working group (exchanges regarding common challenges, sharing good practices, etc. in order to mutually reinforce each other's integrity systems), training sessions organised by the federations in order to collectively train people with an integrity role within the organisations (integrity advisors, complaint managers, etc.) so that they can properly perform their remit, meetings of directors on specific integrity challenges in certain geographical areas, etc.



## Reports in 2025

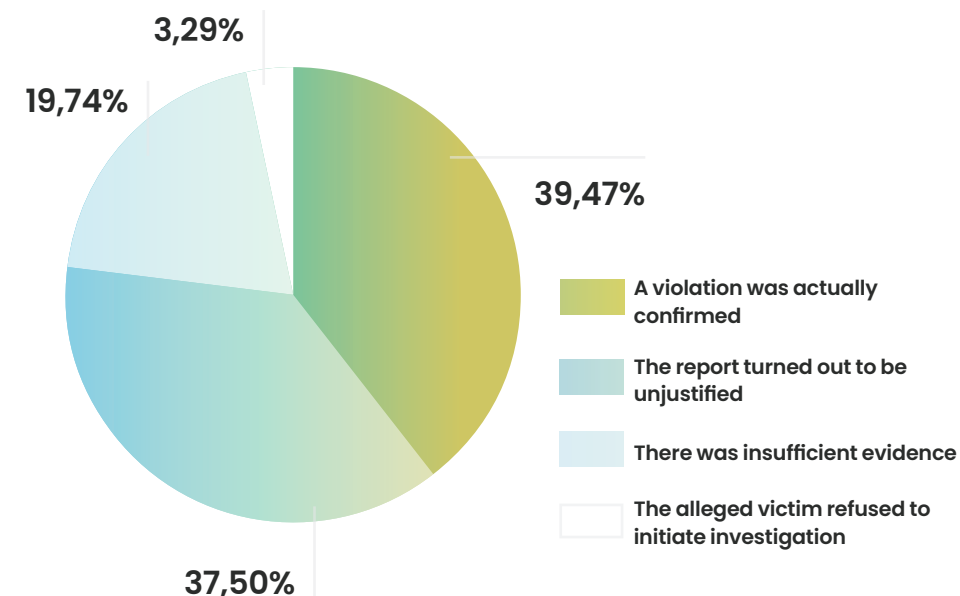
According to the survey, the actors of Belgian Development Cooperation (Enabel, BIO, NGOs, and institutional actors) received a total of 220 reports in 2025.

Looking at the nature of the admissible reports, 43.37% of the reports related to financial integrity and 56.62% related to moral integrity (including 8.43% of a sexual nature).



These reports show that persons reporting and/or (potential) victims of integrity violations find their way to the reporting points and trust that their reports will be handled correctly. In recent years, the sector has had a significant focus on accessible and robust reporting points, which is now visible in the figures.

Of course, not every report of an integrity violation is upheld: a proportion of reports will turn out to be inadmissible or, after investigation, unfounded. Specifically, 26.01% of all reports were declared inadmissible in 2025. The most common reason for inadmissibility is that the report does not involve any (potential) integrity violation. In 39.47% of the admissible reports, an integrity violation was actually confirmed following an investigation. In 37.50% of the admissible reports, the report was found to be unjustified following an investigation, in 19.74% of the cases there was insufficient evidence.



After receiving a report, throughout the investigation and also after the investigation ends, the organisation will always consider what measures it can take to support and protect the person reporting and the (potential) victim. The survey shows that the actors of Belgian Development Cooperation focus closely on this aspect in this regard: access to psychological



and psychosocial support, protective measures against reprisals, suspension of the (potential) perpetrator, good information sharing, etc. During these processes, it is obviously also examined how the perpetrator is sanctioned; this depends on the case, from changes to their work situation (dismissal, change of place of employment, suspension, etc.), moral condemnation (a notice, culpability, written warning, etc.) to referral to the competent authorities (e.g. in the case of a criminal act). Finally, the organisation will always consider how it can learn from the integrity violation and how it can bolster its integrity systems to prevent similar incidents in the future, if possible.

Central Reporting Point

The Central Reporting Point, established by the Royal Decree of 28 February 2023 and further defined in a circular, was set up within the DGD as a mechanism for reporting abuses in Belgian Development Cooperation when the first-line contact points provided by the actors of Belgian Development Cooperation fail to take action, or take action that is insufficient. Reports can be submitted via the online form at <https://integritycomplaint.be>.<sup>7</sup> A communication campaign was rolled out with the goal of clarifying the role of the reporting point within the broader integrity framework of Belgian Development Cooperation. A direct link to the portal of the Central Reporting Point was added on the websites of the Belgian posts to increase visibility and accessibility.

In 2024, this communication campaign resulted in 21 reports. However, it turned out that none of the reports related to abuse within Belgian Development Cooperation. 32 reports were received in 2025, none of which were found to be substantively admissible either. Where possible, the individuals reporting an incident were referred to authorized services at home and abroad.

A further clarification of the mandate of the reporting point was published on the webpage, with the result that there were fewer inadmissible reports by the end of 2025. Based on these experiences, additional communication campaigns will be rolled out in 2026 to further clarify the role and powers of the Central Reporting Point.

<sup>7</sup> Alternative link: <https://diplomatie.belgium.be/en/integrity>

2025  
IN FIGURES

Top 20 recipient countries of DGD Official Development

Assistance in 2025 (millions of euros)

| Country      | 2025 DGD |
|--------------|----------|
| DRCONGO      | 104.49   |
| BURKINA FASO | 28.02    |
| UGANDA       | 27.80    |
| BURUNDI      | 27.18    |
| NIGER        | 26.29    |
| PALESTINE    | 24.71    |
| SENEGAL      | 20.06    |
| UKRAINE      | 18.16    |
| BENIN        | 17.82    |
| MALI         | 14.59    |
| TANZANIA     | 10.73    |
| GUINEA       | 10.71    |
| MOROCCO      | 10.65    |
| MOZAMBIQUE   | 6.95     |
| PERU         | 4.07     |
| ECUADOR      | 3.92     |
| RWANDA       | 3.62     |
| CAMBODIA     | 3.48     |
| BOLIVIA      | 3.43     |
| PHILIPPINES  | 3.06     |



Directorate-General for Development (DGD) – in million euros

| Governmental cooperation                             | 2023   | 2024   | 2025   |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|
| Belgian Development Agency (Enabel)                  | 199,97 | 207,78 | 212,02 |
| Consolidation of society and good governance         | 26,85  | 8,58   | 7,20   |
| Management costs of Enabel                           | 24,40  | 23,05  | 25,57  |
| State-to-state loans                                 | 6,69   | 8,01   | 5,57   |
| Sub-total Governmental cooperation                   | 257,91 | 247,41 | 250,35 |
| Non-governmental cooperation (program based finance) |        |        |        |
| Federations                                          | 3,05   | 3,26   | 3,27   |
| NGO                                                  | 148,50 | 151,23 | 146,10 |
| Institutional actors                                 | 103,06 | 105,93 | 103,13 |
| Scientific institutions                              | 4,26   | 1,59   | 5,69   |
| Other non-governmental actors                        | 3,05   | 2,94   | 2,02   |
| Sub-total Non-governmental cooperation               | 261,91 | 264,95 | 260,21 |
| Multilateral Cooperation                             |        |        |        |
| Mandatory multilateral contributions                 | 13,17  | 11,98  | 11,66  |
| Voluntary multilateral contributions                 | 107,33 | 124,62 | 74,74  |
| European Development Fund and Bank                   | 66,57  | 48,43  | 26,04  |
| World Bank Group                                     | 126,19 | 285,86 | 114,58 |
| Regional development banks                           | 54,11  | 73,36  | 35,62  |
| Multilateral debt cancellation                       | 33,72  | 32,33  | 28,00  |
| Sub-total Multilateral cooperation                   | 401,08 | 576,58 | 290,63 |

| Entrepreneurship, science and technology (from 2017)     | 2023     | 2024     | 2025     |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
| Science, technology and innovation: Belgian actor        | 0,14     | 1,20     |          |
| Science, technology and innovation: International actors | 4,00     | 4,00     | 4,00     |
| Local entrepreneurship, fair trade                       | 35,81    | 52,03    | 35,93    |
| International knowledge centres                          | 1,09     | 1,05     | 0,75     |
| Humanitarian programmes                                  | 217,99   | 187,90   | 170,00   |
| Climate policy                                           | 101,51   | 100,82   | 102,18   |
| Awareness-raising in Belgium                             | 2,47     | 2,81     | 1,99     |
| Administration, evaluation, other                        | 1,99     | 2,18     | 1,92     |
| Total DGD                                                | 1.285,90 | 1.440,92 | 1.117,97 |



**COLOPHON**

**Coordination and drafting**

Directorate-General for Development  
Cooperation and Humanitarian Aid (DGD)

**Design and production**

AdGrafics Design Studio

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1000 Brussels

**Legal deposit**

D/2026/0218/009  
May 2026

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Foreign Trade and  
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